

FLORIDA OWNER-BUILDER PERMIT KIT

Sign the disclosure · Record the notice · Pass the inspections

Project Address: _____

City / Town: _____

County: _____

Building Department: _____

Clerk of Court (for the NOC): _____

Owner-Builder: _____

Permit Application Date: _____

In Florida the clerk who records your Notice of Commencement is a permitting contact too — no recorded notice, no first inspection. Read FL.1 first.

Every Florida statute, rule and threshold in this kit
is cited on the page it appears on — verified September 2026.

BUILD YOUR HOUSE

build-your-house.com

First Edition — 2026

How to Use This Kit

Five working documents, from the disclosure statement you have to sign in person to the certificate of occupancy.

Most states in this series raise the same question first: *will anyone actually inspect this house?* In Florida that question has no purchase. One building code binds every parcel in all 67 counties, every jurisdiction issues permits and inspects, and your local government is not free to write its own residential code instead.

So Florida's real question is a different one: **how many separate offices have to say yes before the building department will even look at your application?** The building permit is one of them. Depending on your lot, the others can include the county **clerk of court**, the Department of Environmental Protection for your septic system, a **water management district** for your well, and — if you are seaward of the coastal construction control line — the Department of Environmental Protection again, for an entirely separate state permit.

The good news is that Florida's owner-builder exemption is one of the most generous in the country, and it is **two** exemptions rather than one — the general contracting exemption and a separate electrical exemption, written in different words, with different limits. Almost every guide collapses them into one rule and gets the limits wrong. **FL.1 keeps them apart**, because which one you are relying on changes what you may build and when you may sell it.

WHAT IS IN THE KIT

The five documents

	Document	What it does for you
FL.1	Owner-Builder Exemption Walkthrough	The two exemptions and their different tests, the twelve-point disclosure statement you must sign, and the personal appearance the statute requires. Read this first.
FL.2	Permit Application Checklist	What to gather before you file — the product approval schedule for every exterior opening, the wind design criteria, the energy form, code editions and the fees to budget for.
FL.3	Inspection Sequence	The Notice of Commencement that gates your first inspection, the order the rest happen in, and fields for dates and results.
FL.4	Where to File Directory	How to establish which jurisdiction your parcel is actually in, the offices beyond the building department, and a page to write down every one you confirmed.
FL.5	Forms & Documents Index	Each document you will meet: what it is, when it is due, and which office it comes from.

HOW TO USE IT

- **Start with FL.1.** The exemption is real and it is generous, but it is conditional — and two of its conditions (appearing in person, signing the disclosure) happen at the counter, not at your desk. Know them before you go.
- **Work FL.2 with a pen, early.** The item that surprises Florida owner-builders is the product approval schedule: every exterior window, door and skylight has to be identified by an approval number at plan review. That is a purchasing decision disguised as paperwork, and it is much cheaper to make before you order.
- **Record the Notice of Commencement before you call for the first inspection** — not before the final one. It is recorded at the clerk of court, not the building department, and the building department is barred by statute from inspecting until it has a certified copy.
- **Keep FL.3 on the job** and record every inspection as it happens, with the date and the inspector's result.

How these facts were checked — and what this is not

Every Florida claim here was read against its primary source in September 2026 — the Florida Statutes at flsenate.gov, the Florida Administrative Code at flrules.org, and the Florida Building Commission's own code and product approval pages at floridabuilding.org — and is cited where it appears. Where a number genuinely varies by county, the kit says so and gives you a line to write what you confirmed rather than printing a guess. Not legal advice.